

GENERAL STUDIES ASCEND TEST 2

Time Allowed: **Three Hours**

Maximum Marks: **250**

Question Paper Specific Instructions:

1. There are **TWENTY** questions printed in **ENGLISH**.
 2. All questions are compulsory.
 3. The number of marks carried by a question/part is indicated against it.
 4. Word limit in questions, if specified, should be adhered to.
 5. Any page or portion of the page left blank in the Question-Cum Answer Booklet must be clearly Struck off.
 6. Do furnish the appropriate details in the answer sheet (viz. Name, Email, Roll No, Mobile).
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- Q.1)** Highlight the elements from the Indus Valley Civilization (IVC) that have influenced the contemporary culture of the Indian subcontinent. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.2)** What insights do ancient Indian literature provide about the role and status of women in ancient society? (10 Marks, 150 Words)
- Q.3)** Gandhara art was a hybrid school that reflects the cultural interaction between India and the Hellenistic world. Elaborate. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.4)** The syncretic nature of the Vijayanagar empire made significant contributions to the development of art and literature. Substantiate with examples. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.5)** Discuss the contributions of various tribal leaders in India's struggle for independence. Substantiate this with examples from different regions. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.6)** 'Women's issues were central to the socio-religious reform discourse.' In this context, highlight the contribution of women leaders of the 19th-century to the emancipation of women. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.7)** The Home Rule Movement significantly influenced Gandhi's 1919 satyagraha movement. Analyze. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.8)** Critically examine the conditions that necessitated the imposition of National Emergency in 1975. (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.9)** The American Civil War effectively embodied and achieved the principles of the American Revolution. Analyze. (10 marks, 150 words)

- Q.10)** To what extent the Treaty of Versailles was responsible for the outbreak of World War II? (10 marks, 150 words)
- Q.11)** The Shakas-Kushans introduced new elements into Indian culture, significantly enriching its cultural fabric. Elucidate (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.12)** The emergence of Jainism and Buddhism had significant impact on the development of architecture in ancient and medieval India. Substantiate. (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.13)** "Mughal painting is a rich amalgamation of different cultural influences." Discuss how the Mughal School represented a synthesis of Persian, Indian and European styles. (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.14)** Why did the East India Company (EIC) succeed in establishing rule over India, while efforts by other European powers failed to secure a firm foothold in the country? (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.15)** The ideology of the "white man's burden" thinly veiled the realities of a despotic Raj that continuously impoverished the country. Comment. (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.16)** Different land revenue systems were introduced by the British colonial regime in India for economic, political, and administrative reasons. Discuss. (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.17)** Highlight the key features of Lord Ripon's new approach. What were the long-term effects of the period of his governorship? (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.18)** Before Gandhi's arrival, the national movement was characterized by a narrow social and political base, concentrated class interests, and limited demands. In what ways did Mahatma Gandhi change the nature of the freedom struggle's ? (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.19)** Why is 1960s referred to as the 'dangerous decade'? How did India overcome the challenges faced during this period? (15 marks, 250 words)
- Q.20)** Highlight the key factors that precipitated the Russian Revolution of 1917 and discuss its far-reaching consequences. (15 Marks, 250 Words)